

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Alliance system formation

1882 -> Triple Alliance: Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy

1894 -> France and Russia ally

1904 -> Entente Cordiale

1907 -> Britain and Russia complete the Entente alignment

MUST REMEMBER: Alliance blocs, arms competition, imperial rivalry, nationalism and Balkan crises created structural danger; Sarajevo was the trigger and the July Crisis converted a regional assassination into general war through state choices.

ASCHII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Four structural tensions

NAVAL RACE -> Britain fears relative German sea power

ALSACE-LORRAINE -> French revanchist grievance

ENCIRCLEMENT -> Germany reads Entente as strategic pressure

BALKANS -> Austria and Russia compete through Serbia

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Balkan crisis ladder

1908 -> Austria-Hungary annexes Bosnia

1911 -> Agadir sharpens Anglo-German mistrust

1912-13 -> Balkan Wars strengthen Serbia

1914 -> Austria seeks to curb Serbian nationalism

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: July trigger and first decision

28 JUNE -> Princip assassinates Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo

ULTIMATUM -> Austria frames demands Serbia cannot fully accept

28 JULY -> Austria-Hungary declares war on Serbia

RULE -> assassination triggers; Vienna chooses war

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Escalation chain

GERMAN SUPPORT -> Austria takes hard line

RUSSIAN MOBILISATION -> conflict becomes great-power crisis

1/3 AUG -> Germany declares war on Russia and France

4 AUG -> Belgium violated; Britain enters

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Balance-of-power case

BLOCS -> Europe divided into counterweights

ENCIRCLEMENT -> Germany fears relative decline

NAVAL RATIO -> Britain watches Channel and fleet balance

BALKANS -> each crisis scored as a power transfer

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Motives balance cannot absorb

AUSTRIA -> multinational empire's survival

SERBIA -> South Slav national unification

FRANCE -> Alsace-Lorraine revanchism

GERMANY/RUSSIA -> preventive timing and prestige

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Mobilisation as mechanism

RUSSIA MOBILISES -> Germany sees narrowing time

GERMAN PLAN -> attack France through Belgium

TIMETABLES -> military sequence compresses diplomacy

RESULT -> strategic plans widen a regional war

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Likelihood versus inevitability

LIKELY -> blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust

NOT INEVITABLE -> 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained

BREAK -> July leaders make specific risky choices

VERDICT -> structure raises danger; agency starts war

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Responsibility at two levels

IMMEDIATE -> Vienna's decision to attack Serbia

ENABLING -> Berlin's support and preventive calculation

ESCALATORY -> Russian mobilisation and German plan

SYSTEMIC -> alliances, nationalism, prestige and militarisation

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Triple Entente and Triple Alliance were diplomatic alignments, not automatic identical war plans; Italy's 1914 position and later Ottoman and Bulgarian entry prevent a static two-camp map.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Italy and Britain traps

ITALY -> Alliance member but neutral in 1914; Allies in 1915

BRITAIN -> no binding French alliance obligation

BELGIUM -> immediate legal-political trigger

RULE -> alignment, obligation and entry cause are different

EVIDENCE LIMIT: German risk-taking mattered, but a monocausal guilt story obscures

Austro-Hungarian, Russian, French, British, Serbian and imperial agency and the difference between responsibility and inevitability.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Outbreak answer spine

TRIGGER -> Sarajevo, 28 June

REGIONAL -> Austro-Serb nationality conflict

ESCALATION -> support, mobilisation, Belgium

VERDICT -> balance structure plus distinct motives and choices